

How Eunoia Endorses Universal Happiness through Accessible Mental Health Education By Eileen Liu

Everyone wants to be happy. It's a fundamental human right written into the nation's Declaration of Independence. Yet it would shock many to learn that mental health holds the key to happiness through shaping the mind's perception of events.

The recent COVID-19 Pandemic has given light on this: rates of depression and anxiety increased 6 times, skyrocketing to 50%. Mental health has been deemed a "public health crisis." Instead, mental health is stigmatized, creating barriers to proper support and resources, and this long-standing issue only becomes more severe as it remains unaddressed. Stress not only impacts the current generation, but creates a cycle of downstream consequences for future generations.

2/3s of people have experience 1+ adverse childhood experiences (ACEs), and 1/8 of people have experiences 4+ ACEs. A buildup of toxic stress from an early age creates physical wear and tear on the body, resulting in health problems and destruction of brain cells. This leads to cognitive problems in self-regulation, academics, relationship skills, and mental illness. When left untreated, this leads to financial difficulties and extremely severe public health issues such as gun shootings, robberies, and other large-scale crimes. Individuals who go on to have families bring this adverse environment to their children as well, leading to intergenerational cycles of trauma, abuse, systemic racism, and the wealth gap. While public health, healthcare, mental health, education, and policy seek to mitigate these collateral societal consequences through programs such as CalFresh, Medicaid, etc, the scale is beyond these organizations and they face barriers with lack of funding and resources. No one wants to come forward, yet removing these obstacles has vast positive effects on the psychology of millions of children.

Eunoia gives hope to breaking this cycle by teaching young children resilience to stressful events through building research-backed cognitive, socio-emotional, and physical toolboxes that universally allow kindergarten children, teachers, and parents to simultaneously learn and practice these exercises throughout their lives. The curriculum was built alongside Davina Chan, who believes that "happiness and well-being are best regarded as skills fundamentally no different than learning to play a musical instrument."



Similar early interventions, such as the one by Blackwell and Dweck giving predominately low-achieving minority students 100-minute interventions on study skills and intelligence, have been shown to reverse longtime trends of decreasing academic scores, demonstrating that the consequences of stress are reversible.

Therefore, the curriculum builds on the growth mindset, which gives hope that small everyday changes through using these tools can drive self-directed neuroplasticity to slowly restructure the brain and create positive perceptions of stress, called Eustress. Eustress leads to downstream benefits through strengthening routine and physical needs, leading to better cognitive functioning in coping, growth, self-regularization, and social-emotional skills in relationships, ultimately creating positive shifts in community, empathy, and nurturing relationships leading to cycles of intergenerational resilience and sustained happiness.

Providing free universal mental health education helps shape young brains and society from inside out, leading to universal happiness and elimination of stigmas. To resist barriers of accessibility, Eunoia is built off a human-centered design that focuses on being free and scalable. Through regional expansion of the program, campaigning, advocating for policy change, and digitization, Eunoia's ultimate goal is to create ground toward happier societies.





EUNOIA

Universal Mental Health Education to kindergartener to build resilience that combats the effects of Adverse Childhood Experiences (ACEs) and cycles of inequality.

Types of ACEs

- 1

Neglect
- 2

Abuse
- 3

Racism
- 4

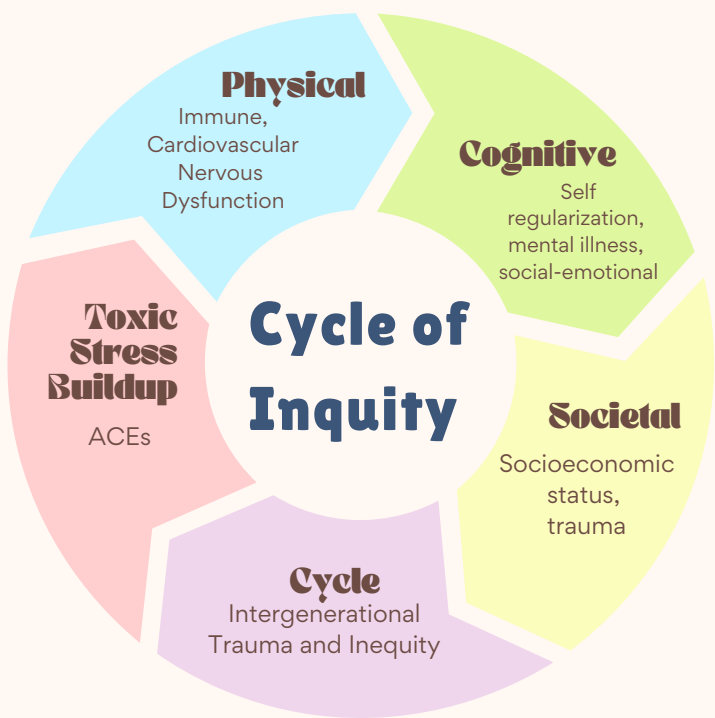
Household Struggles



2/3 adults have 1+ ACEs



1/8 adults have 4+ ACEs



Barriers to help



Perpetually Repairing Societal Collateral Issues



Accessibility to help
Stigmas, fear, cultural barriers



Costly:
People Burnout, overworked, underpaid
Money
Time

Protective Factors

- 1

Education
- 2

Resilience
- 3

Nurturing Caregivers
- 4

Physical Needs & Routine
- 5

Supportive Relationships



Education in Resilience

Free universal mental health education for **kindergarteners, families, and teachers**, that teaches **resilience** through developing **3 toolsets**.



Physical Toolbox

Sleep hygiene, nature, exercise, nutrition, milestones, basic needs, routine

Cognitive Toolbox

Attention, cognitive reappraisal, mindfulness, self-regularization, purpose, coping, optimism, self-esteem, technology use, gratitude, asking for help

Attachment, boundary setting, kindness, empathy, relationship skills, decision making, social/self awareness

Socio-emotional Toolbox

Small changes in brain patterns during early childhood drive sustained happiness!



"Take a deep breathing while humming"
Exercises only take 5 min a day!

